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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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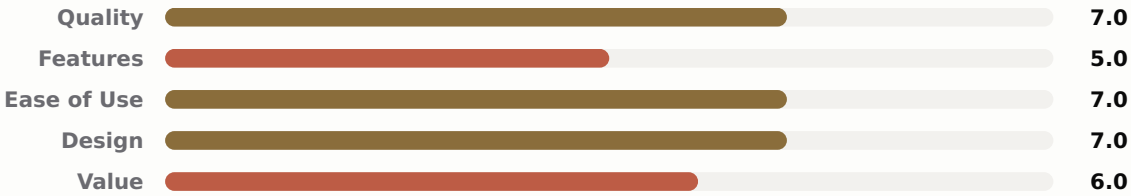
Shopping for a robot vacuum can feel overwhelming with dozens of models promising suction power, smart mapping, and mopping abilities. This guide cuts through the noise by comparing the two Roomba 115X variants and the Shark AI Ultra line using real 2026 prices and verified user ratings.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Is the AutoEmpty Dock Upgrade Worth It?

The Roomba 115X Combo comes in two configurations: one with the AutoEmpty Dock and one without. Both share the same core cleaning system — 3-stage suction, dual rubber brushes, and a vibrating mop pad that works on hard floors. The dock adds a sealed bag-based emptying station that automatically transfers debris from the robot's bin into a disposable bag after each cleaning cycle.

As of October 05, 2026, the docked model sells for $199.99 (down from $469.99) while the undocked version is priced at $139.99 (down from $319.99). The $60 premium buys you the convenience of not having to open the bin after every run. According to owner feedback, the AutoEmpty Dock reduces manual emptying from after each cleaning session to roughly once every 30 days for an average-sized home, freeing up time and limiting exposure to dust.

If you prefer a hands-free experience and have a busy schedule, the dock adds clear daily value. If you don't mind emptying a small bin weekly and want to save $60, the non-dock model delivers identical vacuum and mop performance.

How Does the Shark AI Ultra Compare to the Roomba 115X Combo in Navigation, Suction, and Mopping?



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

The Shark AI Ultra line (including the AV2501S variant) relies on AI-powered laser navigation that creates a detailed map of each room and adapts to furniture moves in real time. The Roomba 115X series uses iRobot's vSLAM visual navigation, which builds a map from ceiling-mounted camera images and works well in typical lighting but can struggle in very dark rooms.

In terms of suction, Shark lists its AI Ultra models with up to 2,700 Pa, while the Roomba 115X Combo delivers around 2,200 Pa — still strong enough for pet hair and daily debris. Both units feature a vibrating mop pad, but the Shark's mop reservoir is slightly larger, offering up to 120 minutes of mopping versus the Roomba's 90 minutes.

Price-wise, the Shark AI Ultra is available for $249.99 (often seen at $250). Compared to the docked Roomba at $199.99, you pay about $50 more for the laser-based navigation and marginally better mopping endurance.

Which Should You Buy?

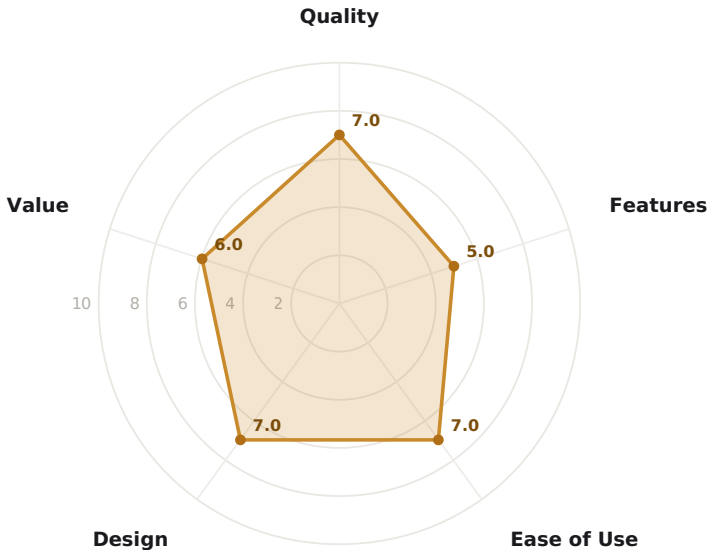
- **Best overall value**: Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock – strong suction, effective mopping, hands-free bin emptying for under $200.
- **Budget pick**: Roomba 115X Combo (no dock) – same cleaning power, save $60 if you don’t mind weekly bin emptying.
- **Premium navigation**: Shark AI Ultra – AI laser navigation, slightly better mopping runtime, ideal if you prioritize map accuracy and don’t mind the higher price.

All prices reflect October 2026 retail links; check the affiliate links for current deals and to support this guide.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

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iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.